

Seller Consultation Guide

For New Realtors

Use this guide to run a professional seller consultation that builds confidence, earns trust, and secures listing opportunities. Includes scripts, prep checklists, and follow-up systems.

How to Use This Guide

- Review this before every listing appointment until your process is automatic.
- Print one copy for your notes and one for your seller packet.
- Customize scripts with your voice while staying compliant with brokerage policy.
- Always follow local/state laws and fair housing requirements.

Consultation Outcome Goals

By the end of the appointment, your seller should understand market reality, pricing strategy, marketing plan, and next steps. Your goal is to become the clear choice for representation.

- Build trust and authority quickly.
- Understand seller timeline, motivations, and expectations.
- Present a data-driven pricing and launch plan.
- Explain showing strategy, offer handling, and negotiation process.
- Secure listing agreement (when appropriate).

Pre-Consultation Checklist (24 hours before)

- Confirm appointment time, location, and all decision-makers attending.
- Research neighborhood comps and active competition.
- Prepare a net sheet estimate and timeline options.
- Prepare listing presentation and marketing samples.
- Review property history, tax info, HOA, and key disclosures.
- Bring listing paperwork per brokerage policy.

Opening Script (2-3 minutes)

"Thank you for meeting with me. My goal today is to understand your priorities, show you what the market says your home can command, and build a clear plan to sell with confidence and as little stress as possible."

Set the Meeting Structure

- Discovery: goals, timeline, and expectations.
- Market Review: comps, condition, and pricing.
- Launch Plan: prep, marketing, showings.
- Offer Strategy: negotiations and decision framework.
- Next Steps: responsibilities and schedule.

Seller Discovery Questions

Start broad, then narrow into specifics that impact strategy.

1) Motivation and Timing

- Why are you selling right now?
- What is your ideal move-out or closing date?
- Is your timeline flexible or fixed?

2) Financial Expectations

- What is your target net from the sale?
- Do you need proceeds for your next purchase?
- Are there repairs or updates already budgeted?

3) Property + Condition

- What updates have been completed in the last 5 years?
- Any known issues buyers might ask about?
- What features do you think buyers love most here?

4) Decision Dynamics

- Who must approve final decisions on pricing and offers?
- How quickly can you respond to offer terms?

Agent Note Prompts

- Urgency level: low / medium / high
- Seller priorities: speed, price, convenience, certainty
- Negotiation style and risk tolerance

Early Red Flags to Address

- Price expectation far above market evidence
- Unwillingness to prepare home for market
- Multiple decision-makers without clear alignment
- Timeline pressure without a backup plan

Educating the Seller: Core Talking Points

Pricing Strategy

- Price drives attention; attention drives offers.
- A strong launch price creates momentum.
- Overpricing can increase days on market and weaken outcomes.

Market Positioning

- Compare against active listings buyers are seeing today.
- Use recent sold data to support realistic expectations.
- Condition and presentation directly impact perceived value.

Marketing Plan

- Professional photos and compelling listing copy.
- MLS exposure, social media, and targeted promotion.
- Open house or private showing strategy based on market demand.

Showing + Offer Process

- How showings are scheduled and feedback collected.
- How to evaluate offer strength beyond price.
- Counteroffer strategy and timeline management.

Client-Friendly Script: Setting Expectations

"I'll guide you from preparation to closing with clear communication and strategy. We'll make decisions using data, not guesswork, and keep your goals at the center the entire time."

Simple Sale Timeline

Prep -> List -> Showings -> Offers -> Negotiation -> Contract -> Inspection/Appraisal -> Closing

Close the Consultation with Confidence

Close Script

"Based on your goals and current market data, I recommend we launch at [price range], complete [prep items], and target a listing date of [date]. If that works for you, I can begin the listing setup today."

Seller Next Steps Checklist

- Review and sign listing agreement (if moving forward).
- Finalize prep/repair list and timeline.
- Confirm showing instructions and availability.
- Approve photos, remarks, and launch date.
- Establish communication cadence for feedback and updates.

Agent Follow-Up (Within 24 hours)

- Send consultation recap email/text.
- Share proposed pricing range with comp highlights.
- Send prep checklist and timeline.
- Confirm next meeting or listing paperwork signing.

Follow-Up Message Template

"Thank you for meeting today. I appreciate the opportunity to help you sell your home. I attached your consultation recap, recommended launch strategy, and next steps. Once you're ready, I can activate the listing timeline right away."

Listing Packet Checklist

- Pricing strategy summary
- Seller net sheet estimate
- Home prep checklist
- Marketing plan one-pager
- Communication expectations

Compliance Reminder

This guide is an educational framework. Always follow your brokerage policies, state licensing requirements, contract obligations, and fair housing laws.

